

ground picture by dragging it to the Create New Layer icon. Next, create a new blank layer by clicking on the Create New Layer icon on the layers palette. The icon looks like a blank page. Even if you go to the brush tool, and draw all over the picture, the original is not damaged. If you click on the eye next to this new layer, the layer will disappear. Similarly, to bring the layer back, click on the empty box. You can also move and hide the layer below the background copy. To delete a layer, click and hold down on the layer icon and drag it to the little trash icon. There's our background copy and background original untouched.

There is a lot more you can do with layers. To get familiar, practice creating them and moving them around.

3.2 Alpha Channels And Layer Masks

Images are made up of three colours—Red, Green and Blue—called *channels* in image-editing circles. All channels are greyscale. If the image is going to be used for online content, where it has to be displayed on a screen, then the image is split into RGB channels, where R, G and B indicate Red, Green and Blue, respectively. Similarly, when the image has to be used for printing, they are split up into 4 channels, each for the ink that is used in printing. These are Cyan, Magenta, Yellow and Black.

The greyscale in the channels basically represent the intensity of that particular colour.

3.2.1 Masks

Pretty similar to what masks do in real life, this principle is very actively used in compositing. Masking is used to determine self-laid limits to our playing around on the images. For example, with several smaller images of friends forming a single image, a mask may be used to highlight just the faces. The advantage of this is that any amount of altering or even non-inviting attire would not show up in the final image! Alpha channels and layer masks are